Ideal Pseudorandom Code, Revisited

Ganyuan Cao

CANS 2026

November 24, 2026







Outline

A Background on Pseudorandom Code

UC Security of PRC

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code

A Gap on Code Structure

Construction for NC-PRCs

Pseudorandom Code (PRC)

First introduced at [CG24][1]

$$(\mathsf{ek}, \mathsf{dk}) \leftarrow \mathsf{PRC}.\mathtt{KGen}(1^\lambda)$$

[1] M. Christ and S. Gunn. "Pseudorandom Error-Correcting Codes". *CRYPTO 2024, Part VI*. vol. 14925. LNCS. 2024. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-68391-6_10

Pseudorandom Code (PRC)

First introduced at [CG24][1]

$$(\mathsf{ek}, \mathsf{dk}) \leftarrow \mathsf{PRC}.\mathtt{KGen}(1^\lambda)$$

$$c \leftarrow \mathsf{PRC}.\mathtt{Encode}(\mathsf{ek}, m)$$

[1] M. Christ and S. Gunn. "Pseudorandom Error-Correcting Codes". *CRYPTO 2024, Part VI*. vol. 14925. LNCS. 2024. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-68391-6_10

Pseudorandom Code (PRC)

First introduced at [CG24][1]

$$(\mathsf{ek}, \mathsf{dk}) \leftarrow \mathsf{PRC}.\mathtt{KGen}(1^\lambda)$$

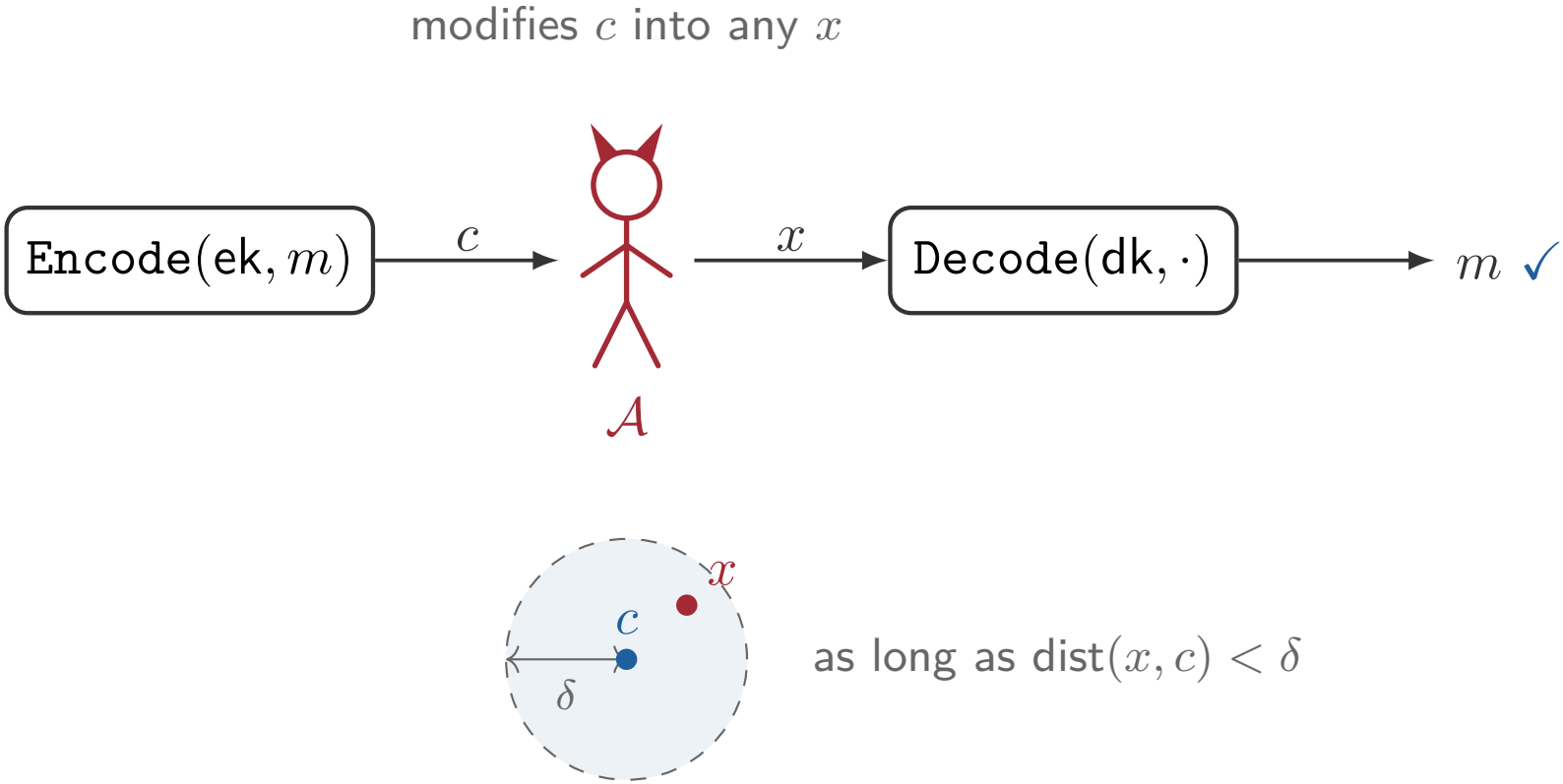
$$c \leftarrow \mathsf{PRC}.\mathtt{Encode}(\mathsf{ek}, m)$$

$$m/\perp \leftarrow \mathsf{PRC}.\mathtt{Decode}(\mathsf{dk}, x)$$

[1] M. Christ and S. Gunn. "Pseudorandom Error-Correcting Codes". *CRYPTO 2024, Part VI*. vol. 14925. LNCS. 2024. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-68391-6_10

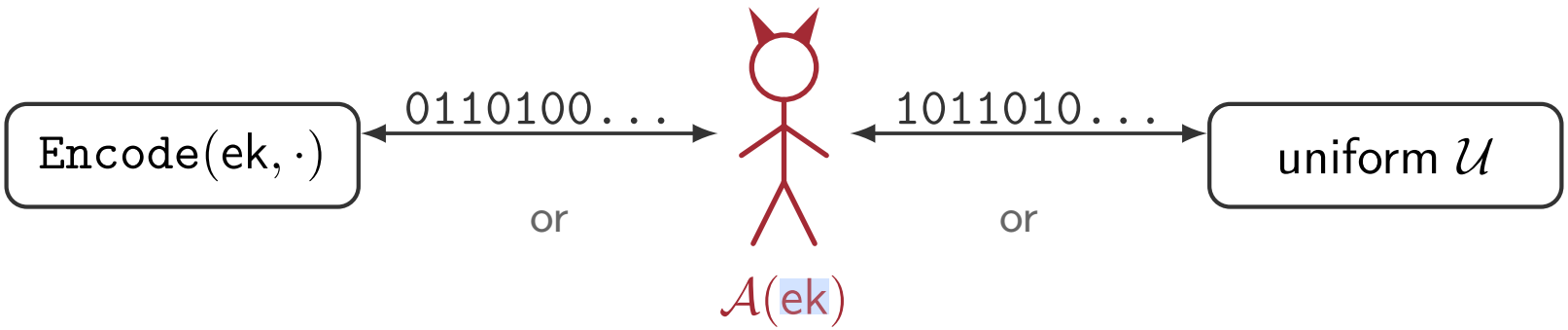
Two Basic Properties of PRC

(Error-Correcting)



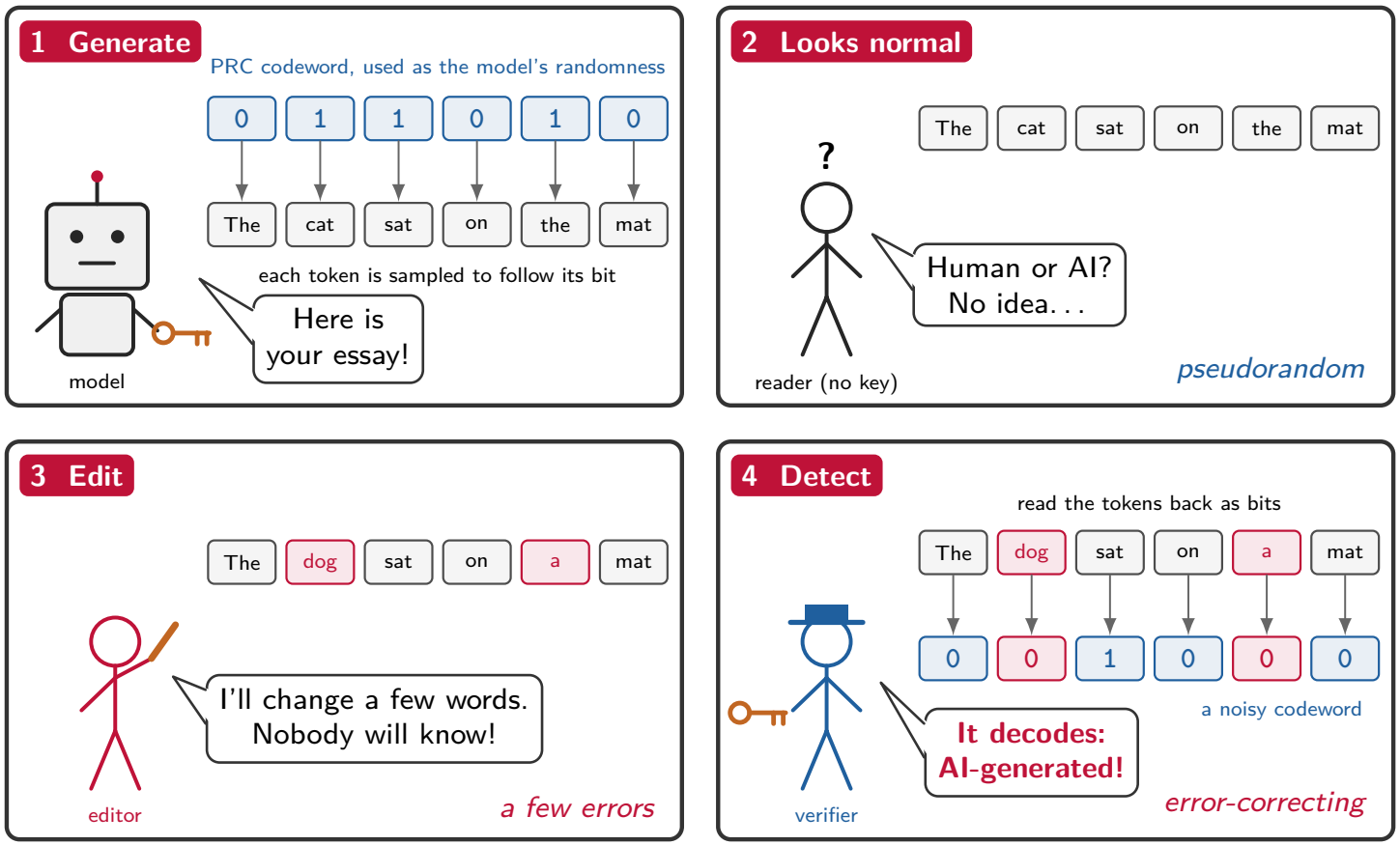
Two Basic Properties of PRC

(Pseudorandomness)



cannot tell which one it talks to
(even given ek for PK)

Application: Watermarking LLMs



Watermarking from PRCs [CG24][2]

[2] M. Christ and S. Gunn. "Pseudorandom Error-Correcting Codes". *CRYPTO 2024, Part VI*. vol. 14925. LNCS. 2024. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-68391-6_10

Standalone Security of PRC

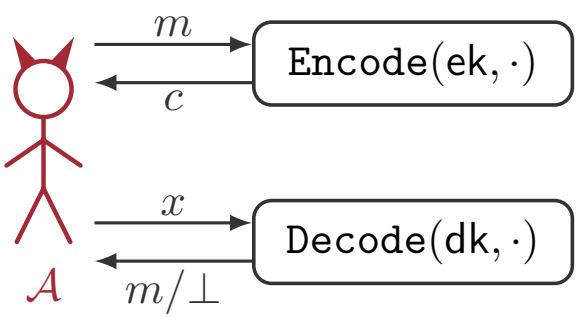
Ideal Security for SK-PRC and CCA Security for PK-PRC [AIr+25][3]:

[3] O. Alrabiah, P. Ananth, M. Christ, Y. Dodis, and S. Gunn. "Ideal Pseudorandom Codes". *57th ACM STOC*. 2025. DOI: 10.1145/3717823.3718309

Standalone Security of PRC

Ideal Security for SK-PRC and CCA Security for PK-PRC [AIr+25][3]:

Real ($b = 0$)

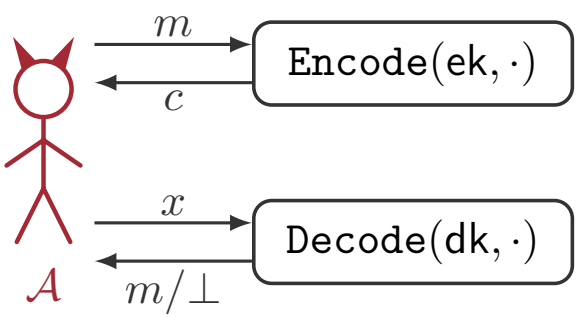


[3] O. Alrabiah, P. Ananth, M. Christ, Y. Dodis, and S. Gunn. "Ideal Pseudorandom Codes". *57th ACM STOC*. 2025. DOI: 10.1145/3717823.3718309

Standalone Security of PRC

Ideal Security for SK-PRC and CCA Security for PK-PRC [AIr+25][3]:

Real ($b = 0$)



Ideal ($b = 1$)

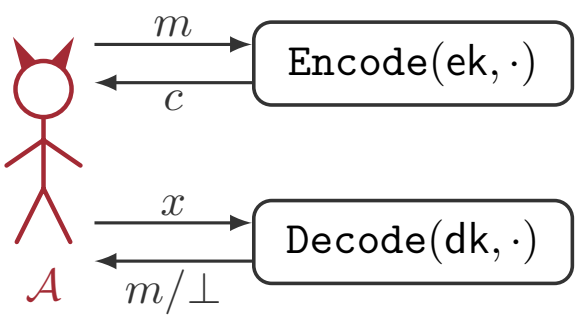


[3] O. Alrabiah, P. Ananth, M. Christ, Y. Dodis, and S. Gunn. "Ideal Pseudorandom Codes". *57th ACM STOC*. 2025. DOI: 10.1145/3717823.3718309

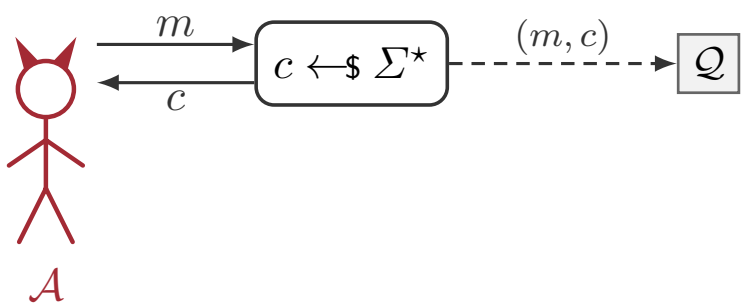
Standalone Security of PRC

Ideal Security for SK-PRC and CCA Security for PK-PRC [AIr+25][3]:

Real ($b = 0$)



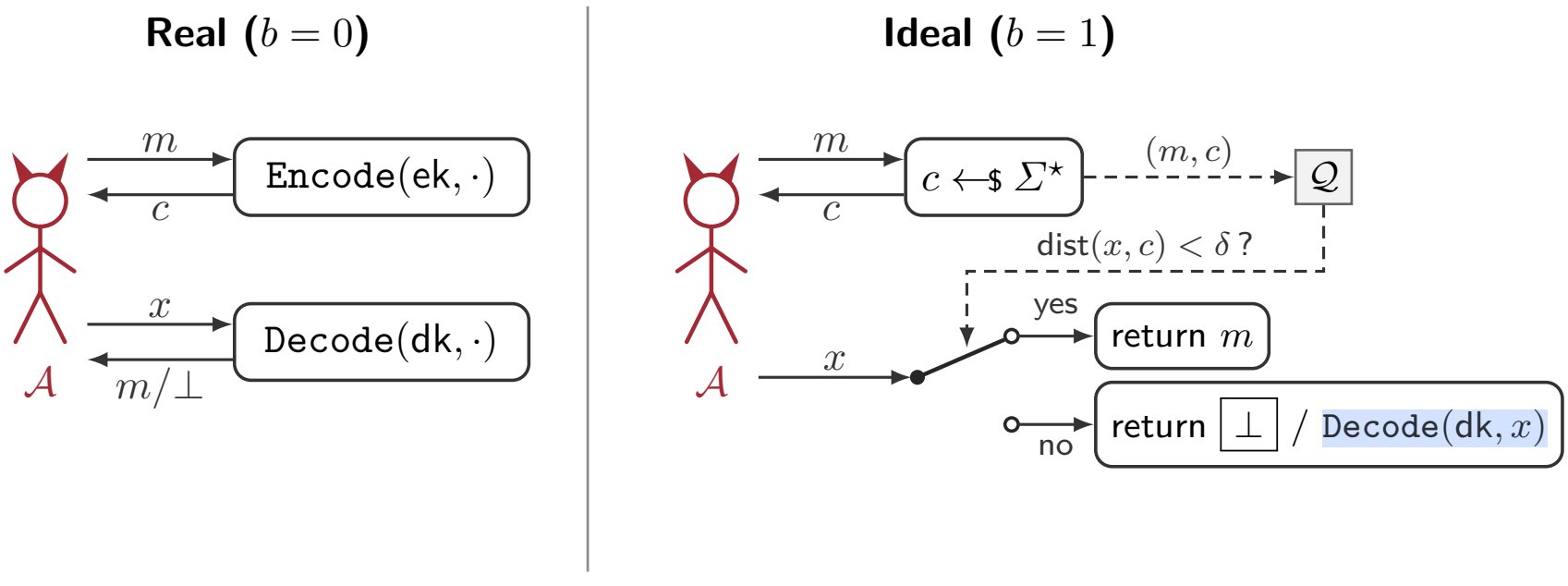
Ideal ($b = 1$)



[3] O. Alrabiah, P. Ananth, M. Christ, Y. Dodis, and S. Gunn. "Ideal Pseudorandom Codes". *57th ACM STOC*. 2025. DOI: 10.1145/3717823.3718309

Standalone Security of PRC

Ideal Security for SK-PRC and CCA Security for PK-PRC [AIr+25][3]:



[3] O. Alrabiah, P. Ananth, M. Christ, Y. Dodis, and S. Gunn. "Ideal Pseudorandom Codes". *57th ACM STOC*. 2025. DOI: 10.1145/3717823.3718309

Outline

A Background on Pseudorandom Code

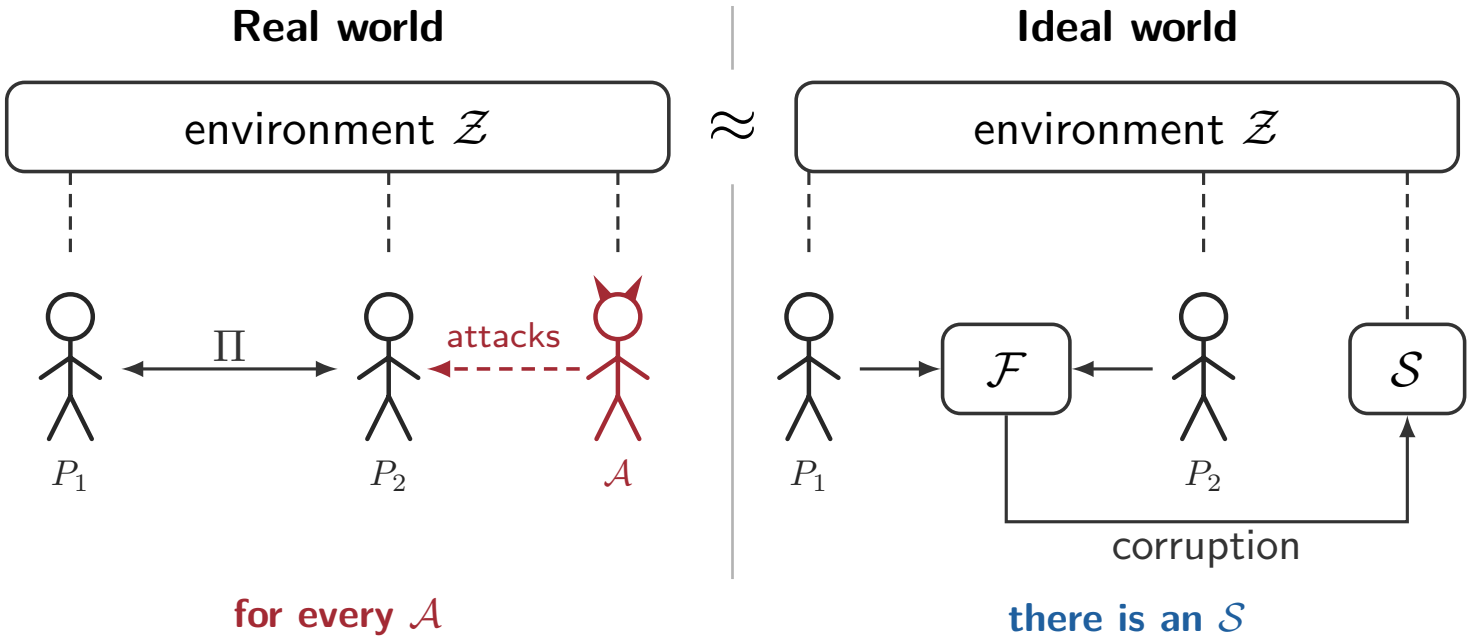
UC Security of PRC

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code

A Gap on Code Structure

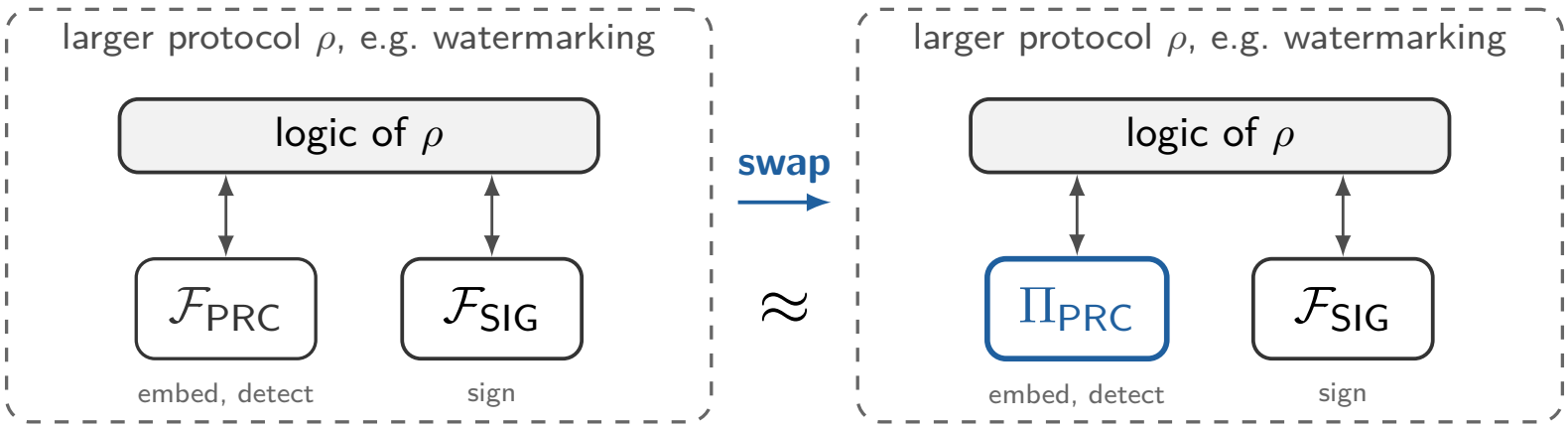
Construction for NC-PRCs

UC Security in a Nutshell



Π *UC-realizes* $\mathcal{F}$: no environment $\mathcal{Z}$ tells the two worlds apart

UC Security in a Nutshell

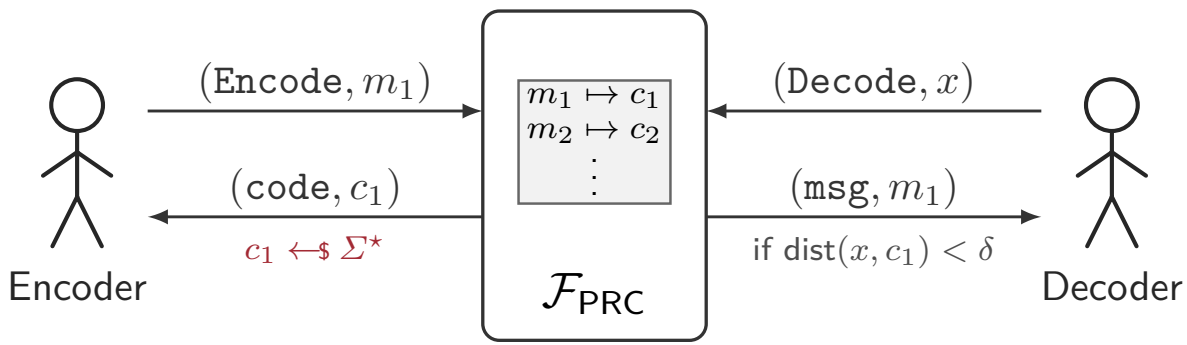


for every larger protocol ρ, whatever else it uses

composition: swap $\mathcal{F}_{\text{PRC}}$ for Π_{PRC} inside ρ, the rest is untouched

UC Security of PRC

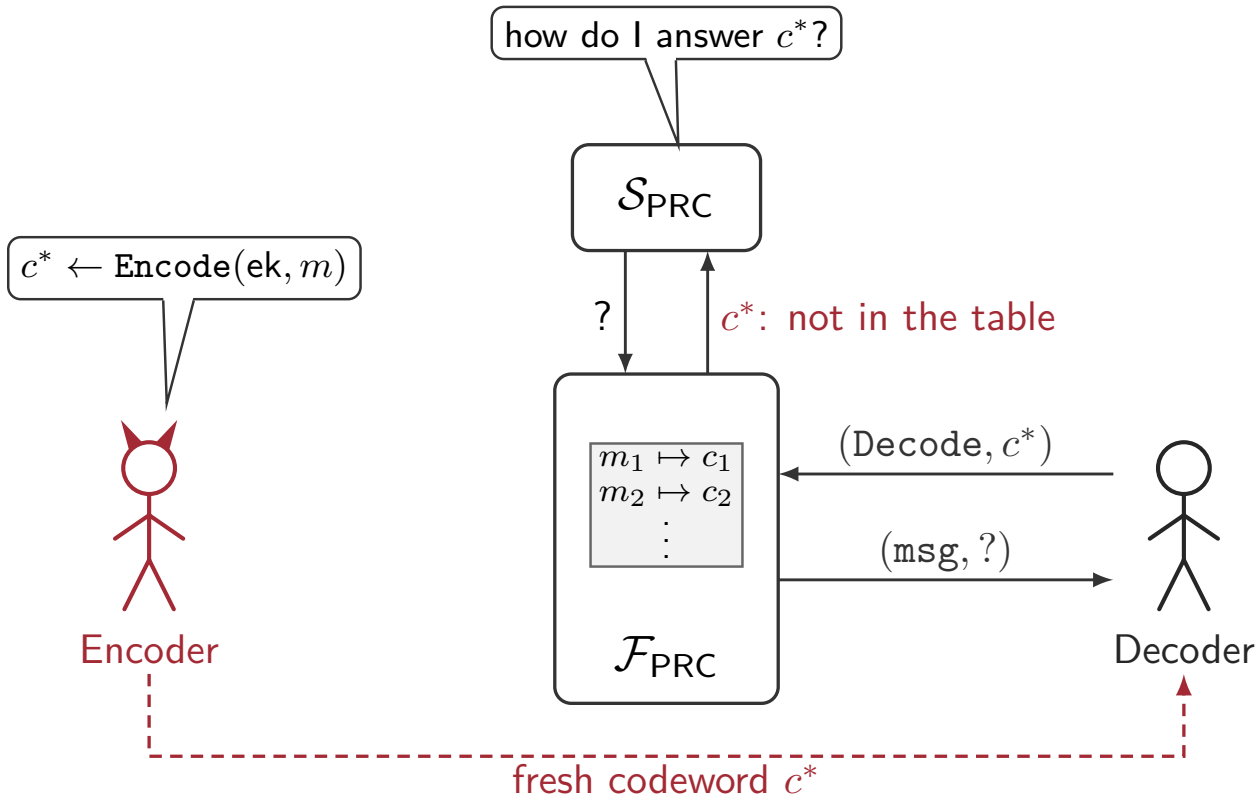
For PRCs, the ideal world is a functionality $\mathcal{F}_{\mathsf{PRC}}$.



random codewords, kept in a table; decoding by lookup

UC Security of PRC

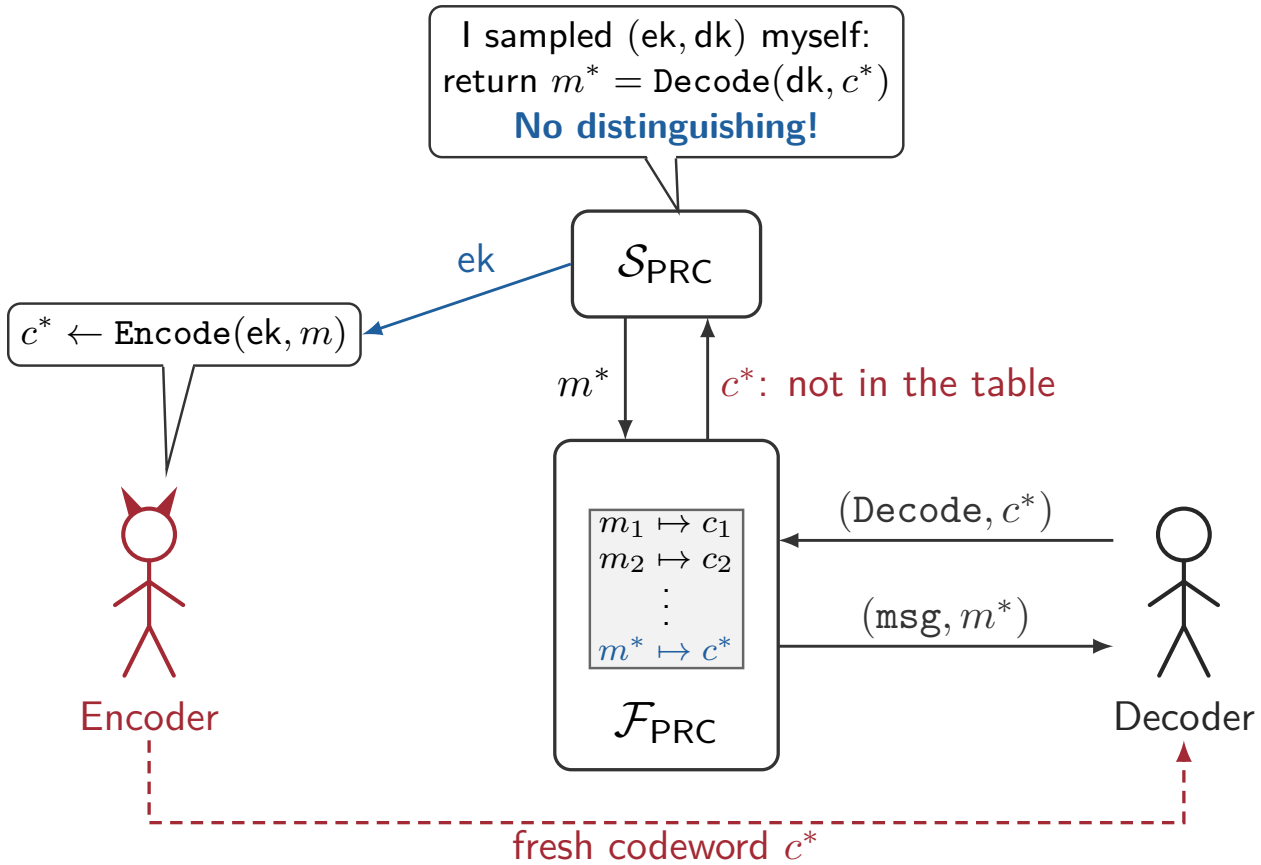
Corruption matters!



a corrupted encoder knows ek, so it makes valid codewords outside the table

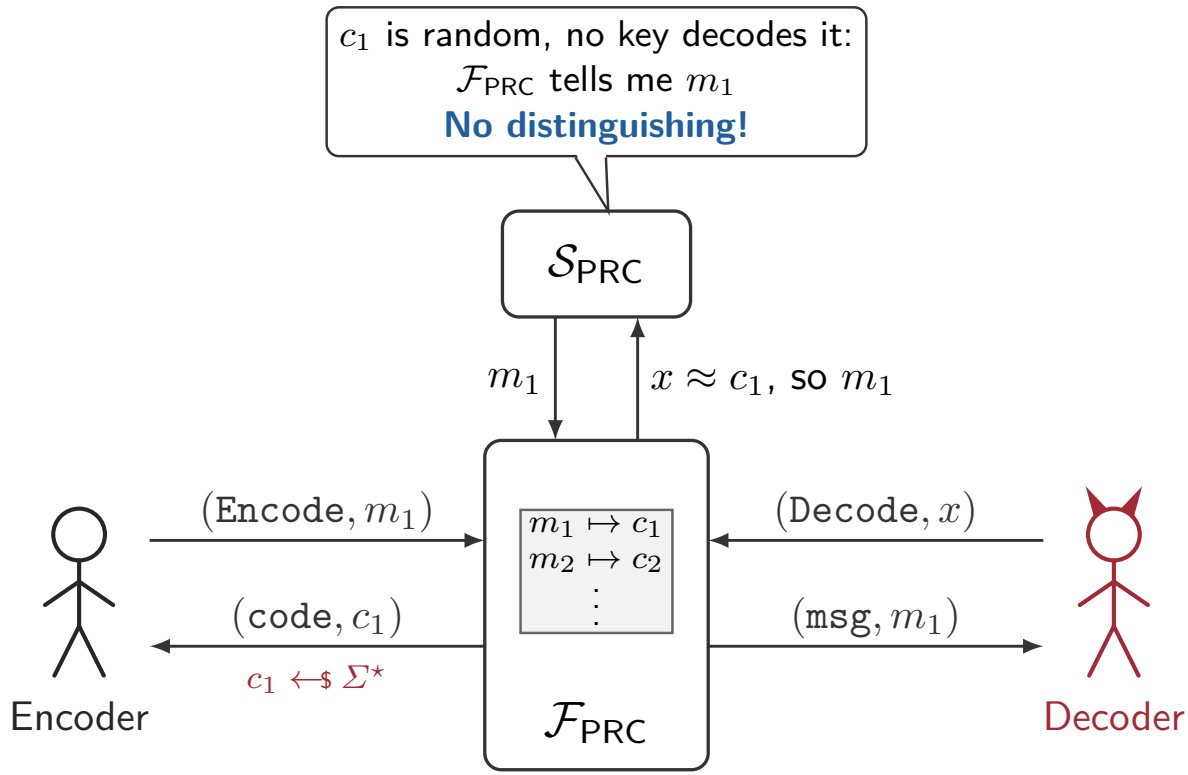
UC Security of PRC

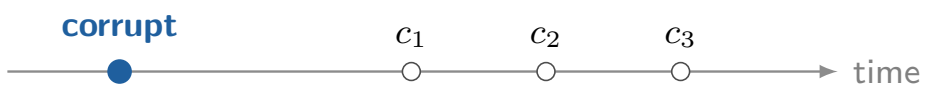
Non-adaptive: the party is corrupted from the start.



UC Security of PRC

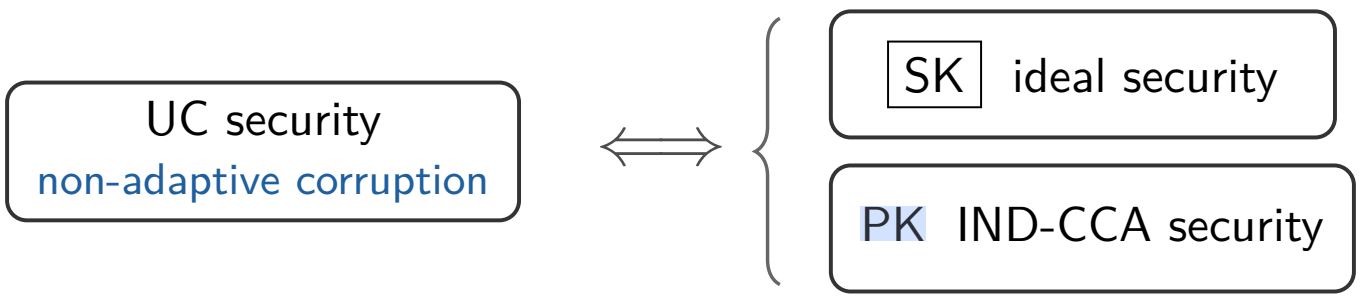
Non-adaptive: the party is corrupted from the start.





Equivalence under Non-Adaptive Corruption

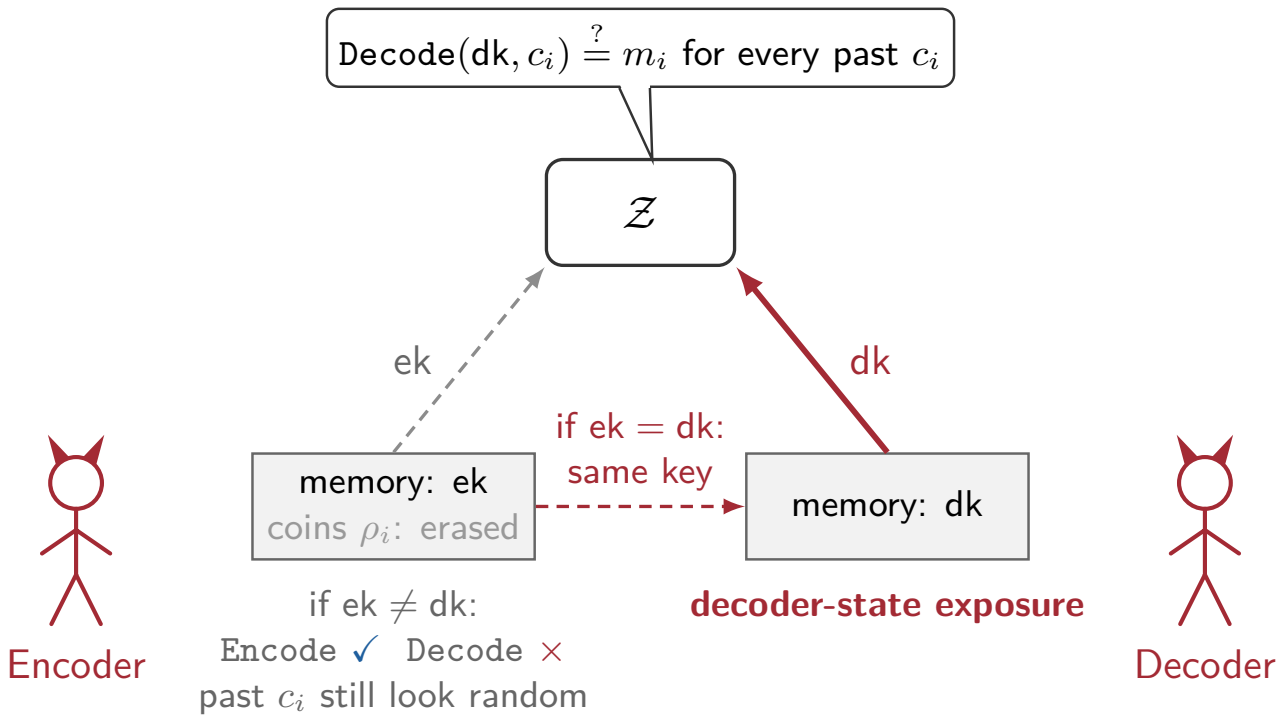
> For **non-adaptive corruption**, UC security asks for *nothing more* than the standalone notions.



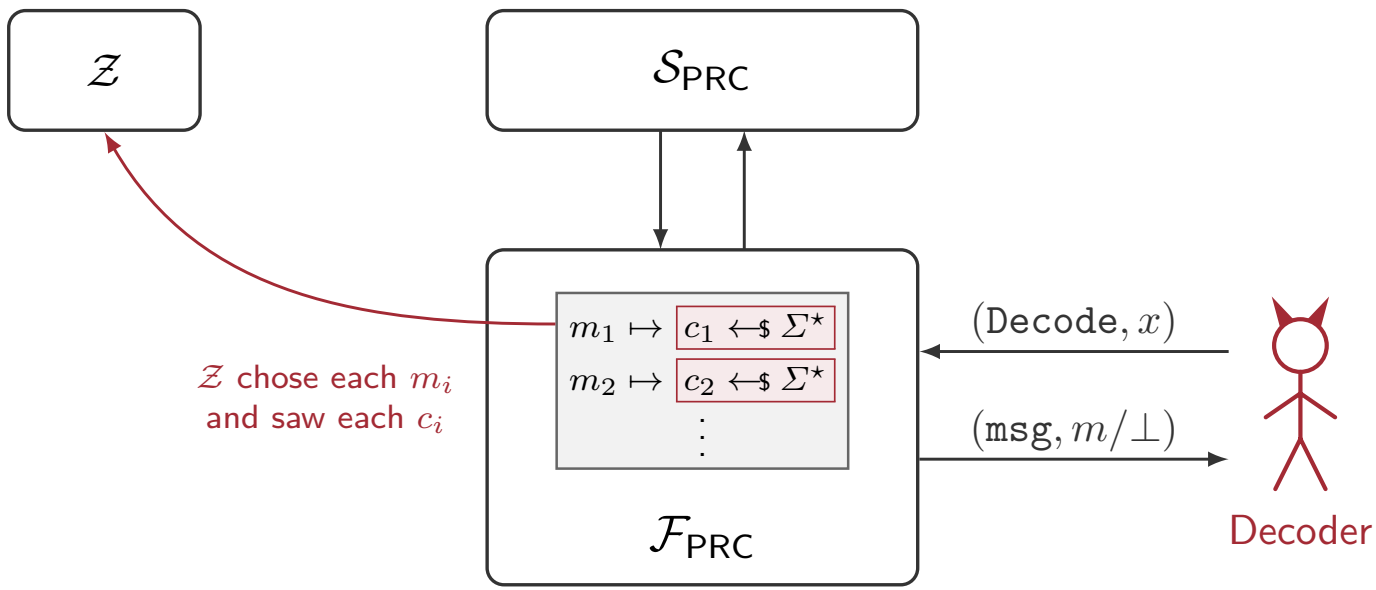
Separation under Adaptive Corruption

Adaptive: corrupted *after* the codewords, so its *memory* leaks.

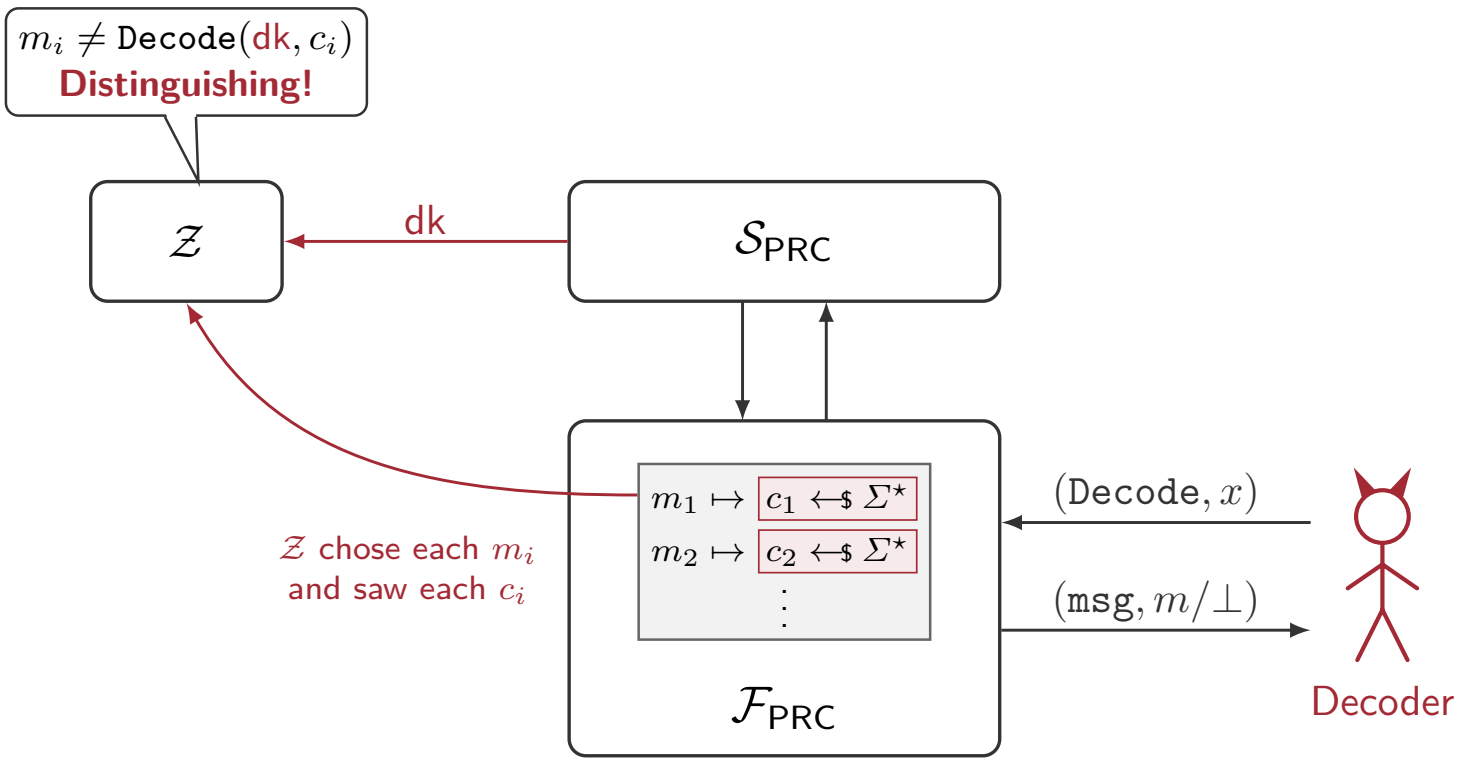




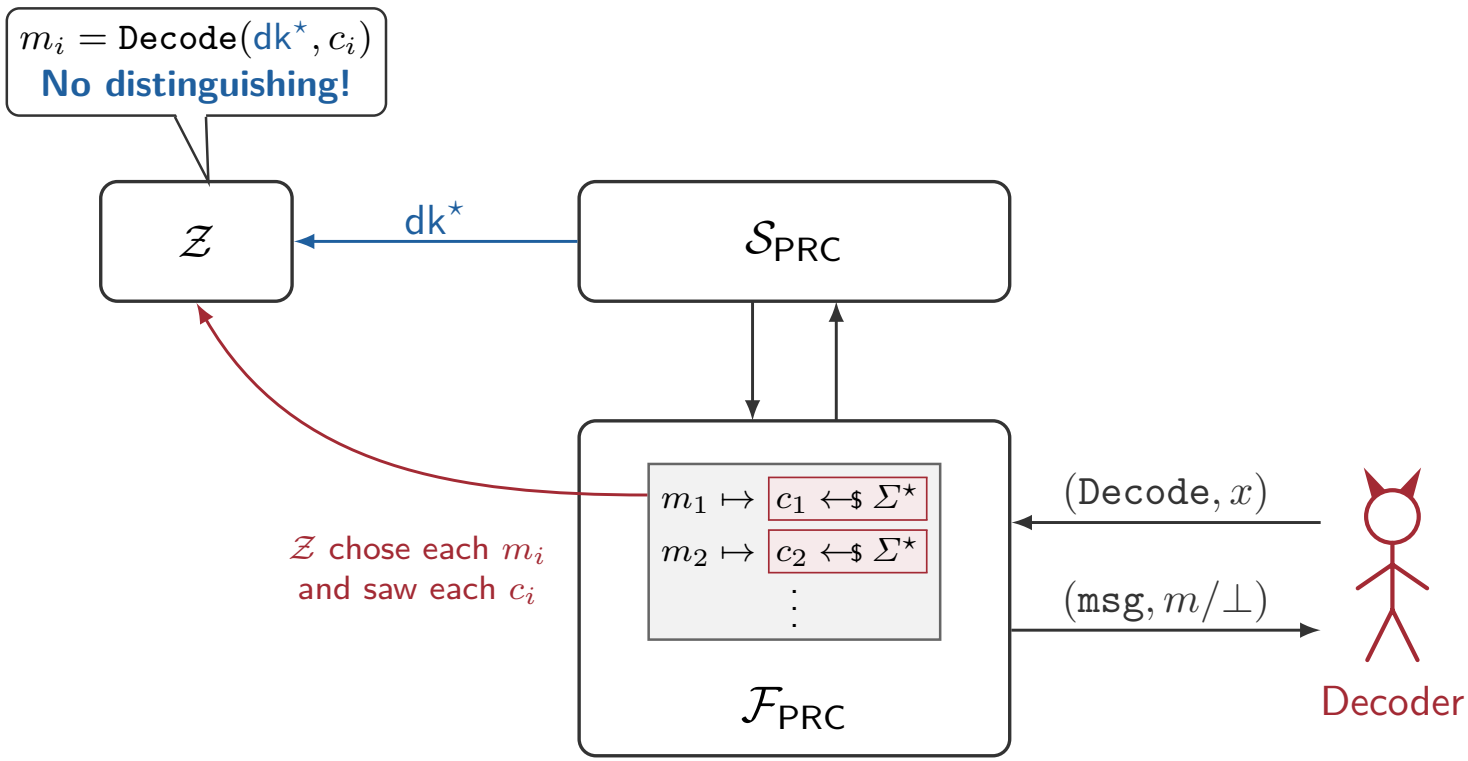
Separation under Adaptive Corruption



Separation under Adaptive Corruption



Separation under Adaptive Corruption



Outline

A Background on Pseudorandom Code

UC Security of PRC

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code

A Gap on Code Structure

Construction for NC-PRCs

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code (NC-PRC)

$(\mathsf{pp}, \mathsf{st}) \leftarrow \mathtt{SimKGen}(1^\lambda)$ simulated keys, with a trapdoor st

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code (NC-PRC)

$(\mathsf{pp}, \mathsf{st}) \leftarrow \mathtt{SimKGen}(1^\lambda)$ simulated keys, with a trapdoor st

$c \leftarrow \mathtt{SimCode}(\mathsf{pp})$ a dummy codeword

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code (NC-PRC)

$(\mathsf{pp}, \mathsf{st}) \leftarrow \mathtt{SimKGen}(1^\lambda)$ simulated keys, with a trapdoor st

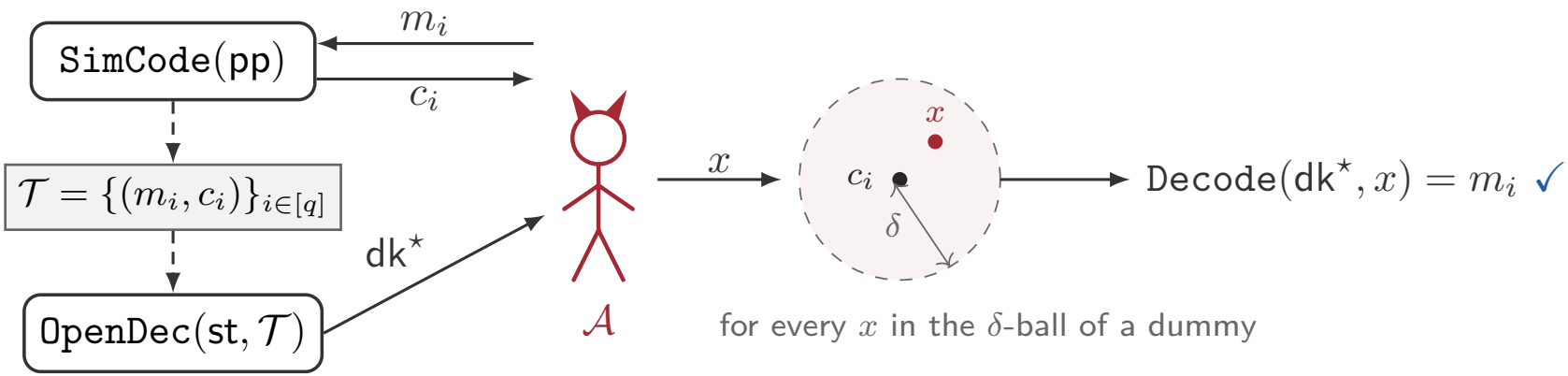
$c \leftarrow \mathtt{SimCode}(\mathsf{pp})$ a dummy codeword

$\mathsf{dk}^\star \leftarrow \mathtt{OpenDec}(\mathsf{st}, \mathcal{T})$ a decoder state explaining $\mathcal{T} = \{(m_i, c_i)\}_i$

Properties of NC-PRC

(δ-opening robustness)

after seeing the dummy codewords and the opened $\mathsf{dk}^\star$, $\mathcal{A}$ cannot find an x near a dummy that decodes wrongly



Properties of NC-PRC

(Decoder-opening indistinguishability)

Properties of NC-PRC

(Decoder-opening indistinguishability)

Real ($b = 0$)

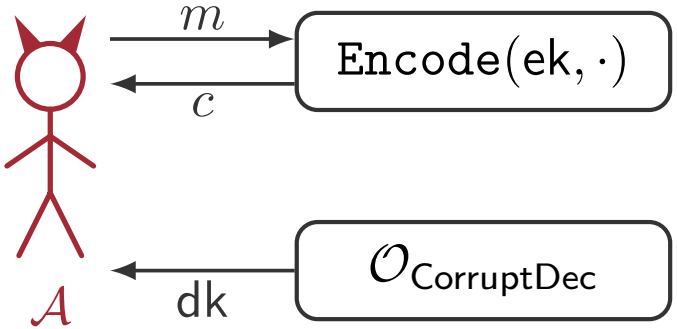


Properties of NC-PRC

(Decoder-opening indistinguishability)

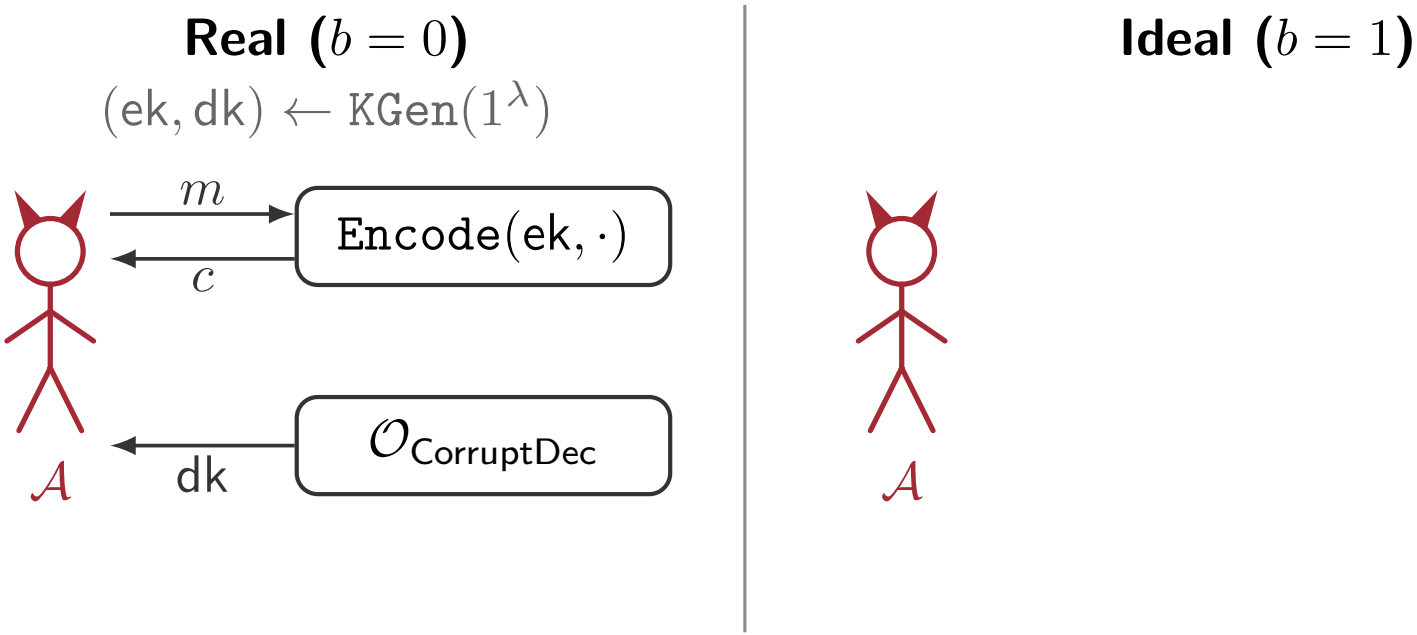
Real ($b = 0$)

$(\mathsf{ek}, \mathsf{dk}) \leftarrow \mathtt{KGen}(1^\lambda)$



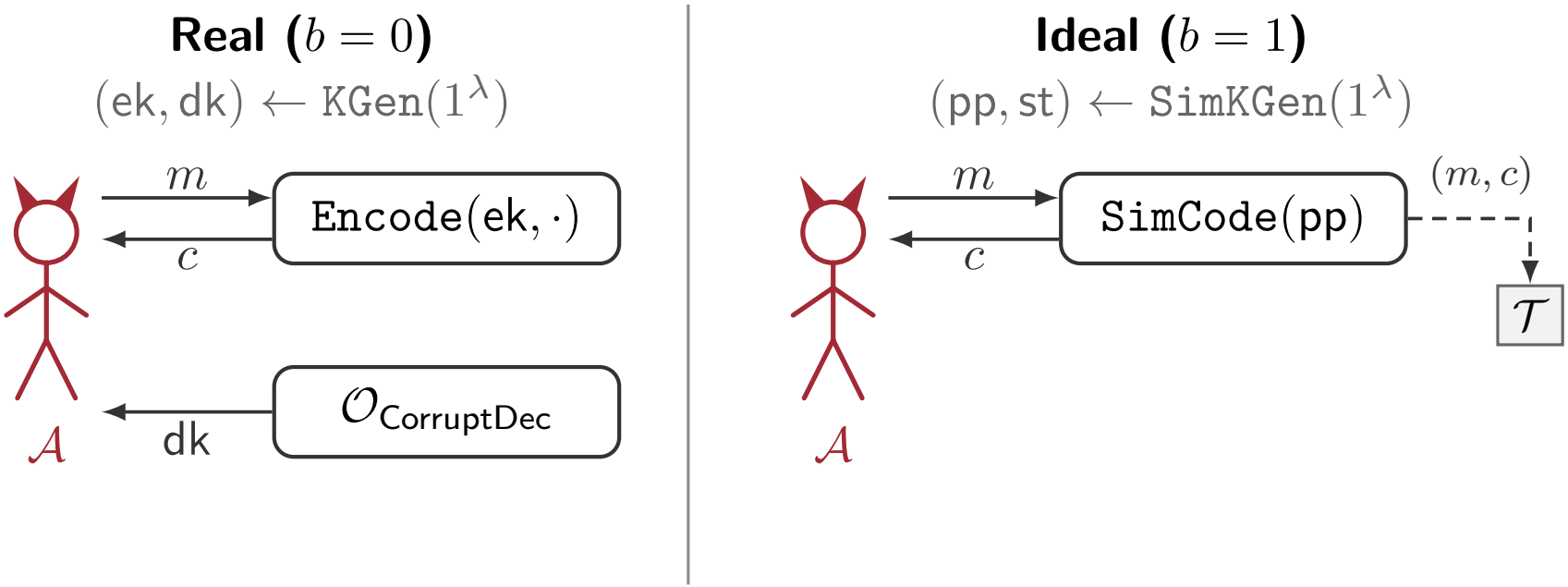
Properties of NC-PRC

(Decoder-opening indistinguishability)



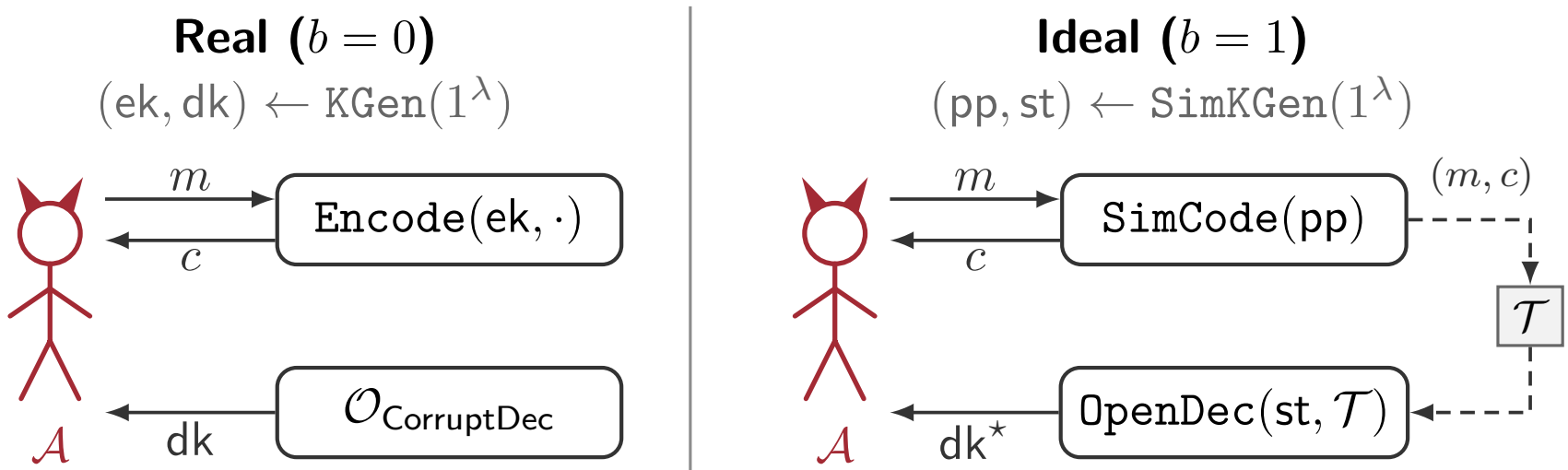
Properties of NC-PRC

(Decoder-opening indistinguishability)



Properties of NC-PRC

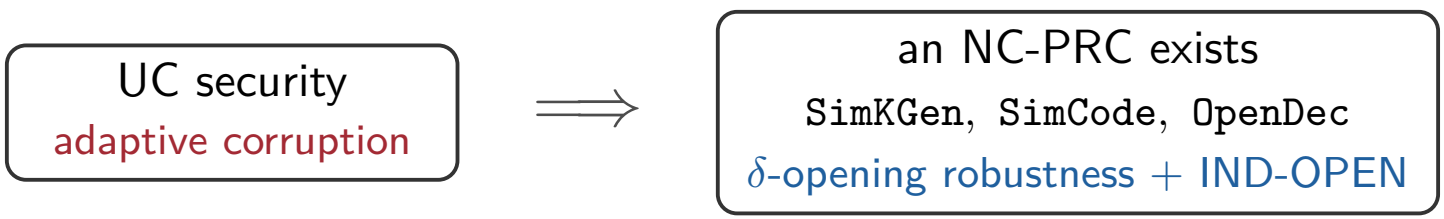
(Decoder-opening indistinguishability)



no post-corruption encoding: $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Enc}}$ returns $\perp$ once corrupted

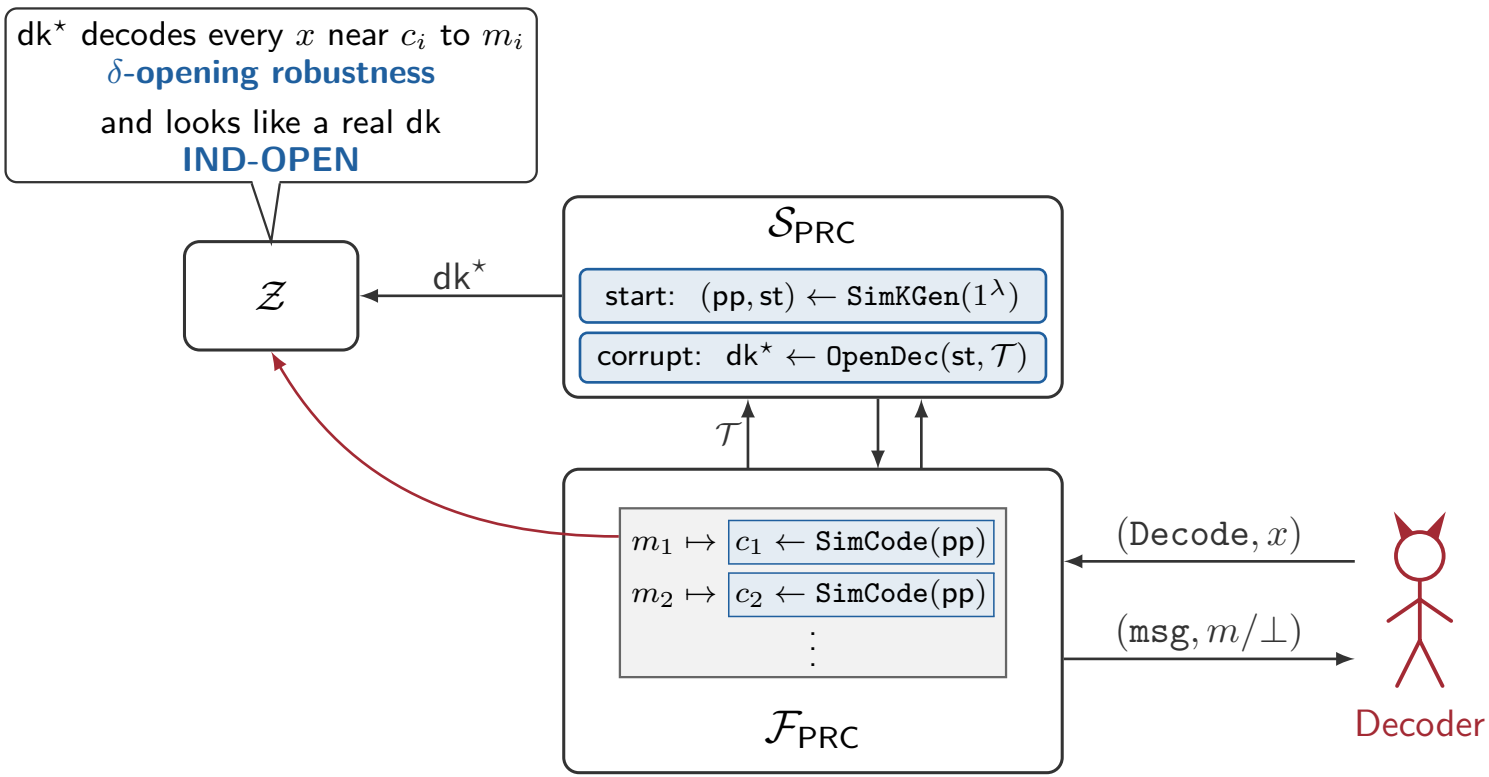
NC-PRC is Necessary

> To be UC-secure against **adaptive corruption**, a PRC *must* admit a (decoder) non-committing code.



NC-PRC is Necessary

> Read $\mathcal{S}_{\mathsf{PRC}}$ of an adaptive UC realization as an NC-PRC.



Outline

A Background on Pseudorandom Code

UC Security of PRC

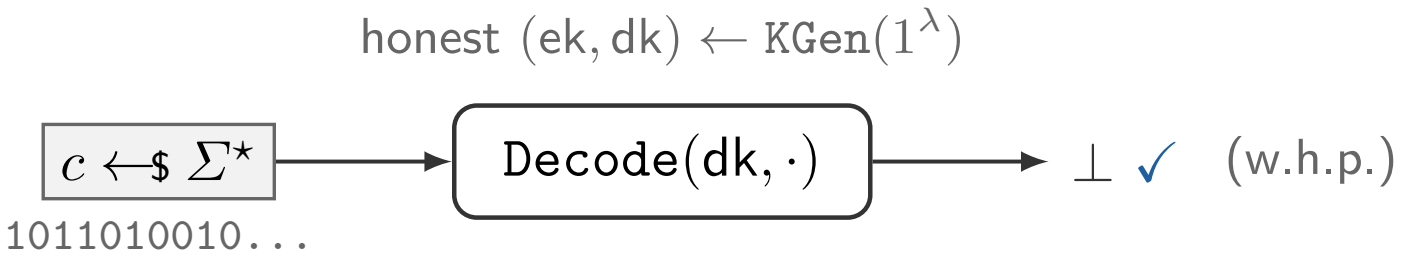
(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code

A Gap on Code Structure

Construction for NC-PRCs

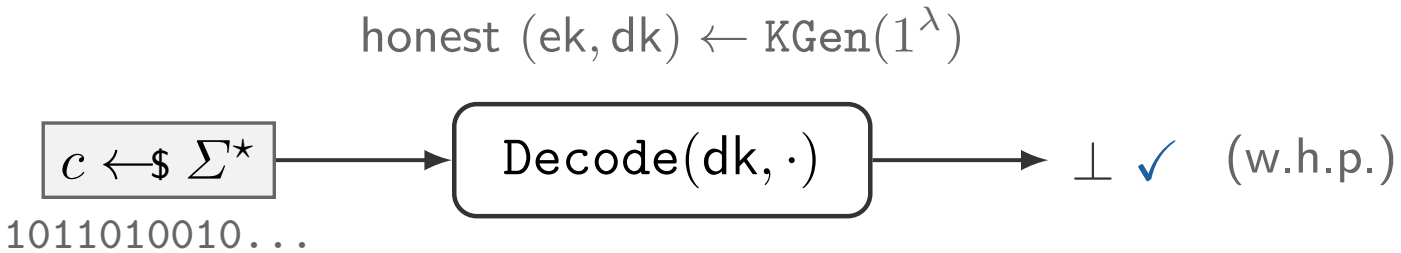
A Gap on Code Structure

(Soundness)

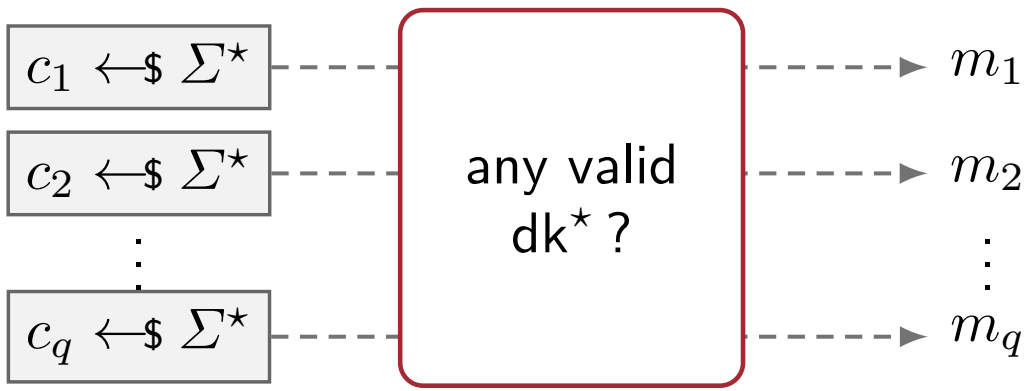


A Gap on Code Structure

(Soundness)



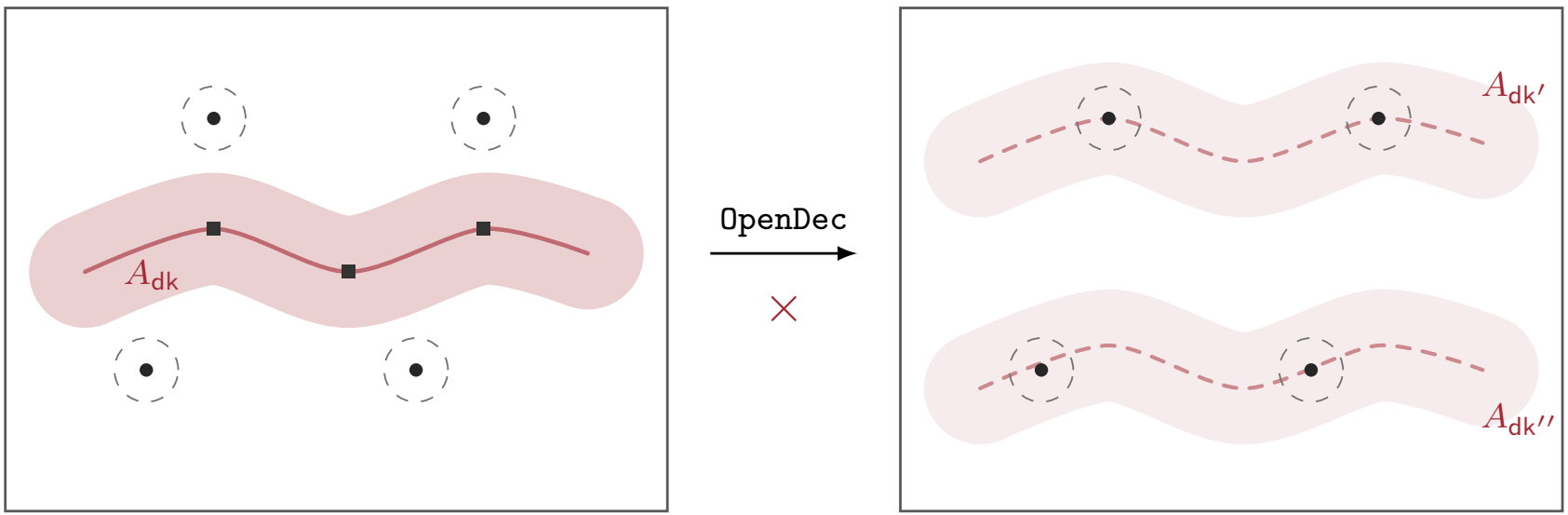
(Low Opening Capacity) for a target $\mathbf{m} = (m_1, \ldots, m_q) \in \Sigma^q$



$\nexists\,\mathsf{dk}^\star$ **(w.h.p.)**: no single key decodes every c_i to its target m_i

A Gap on Code Structure

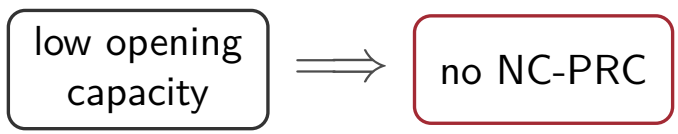
(Low Opening Capacity) valid keys are too *rigid*



valid keys only move the band, never reshape it: none covers all the δ-balls

A Gap on Code Structure

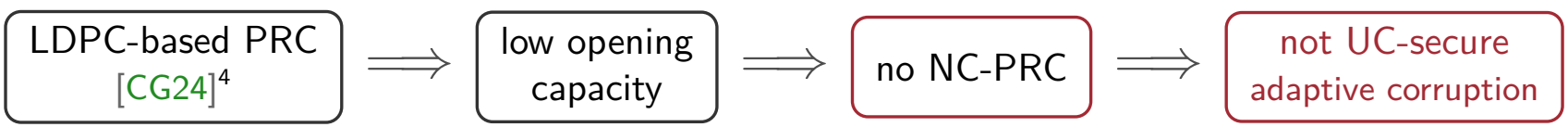
> Low opening capacity rules out non-committing codes.



A Gap on Code Structure

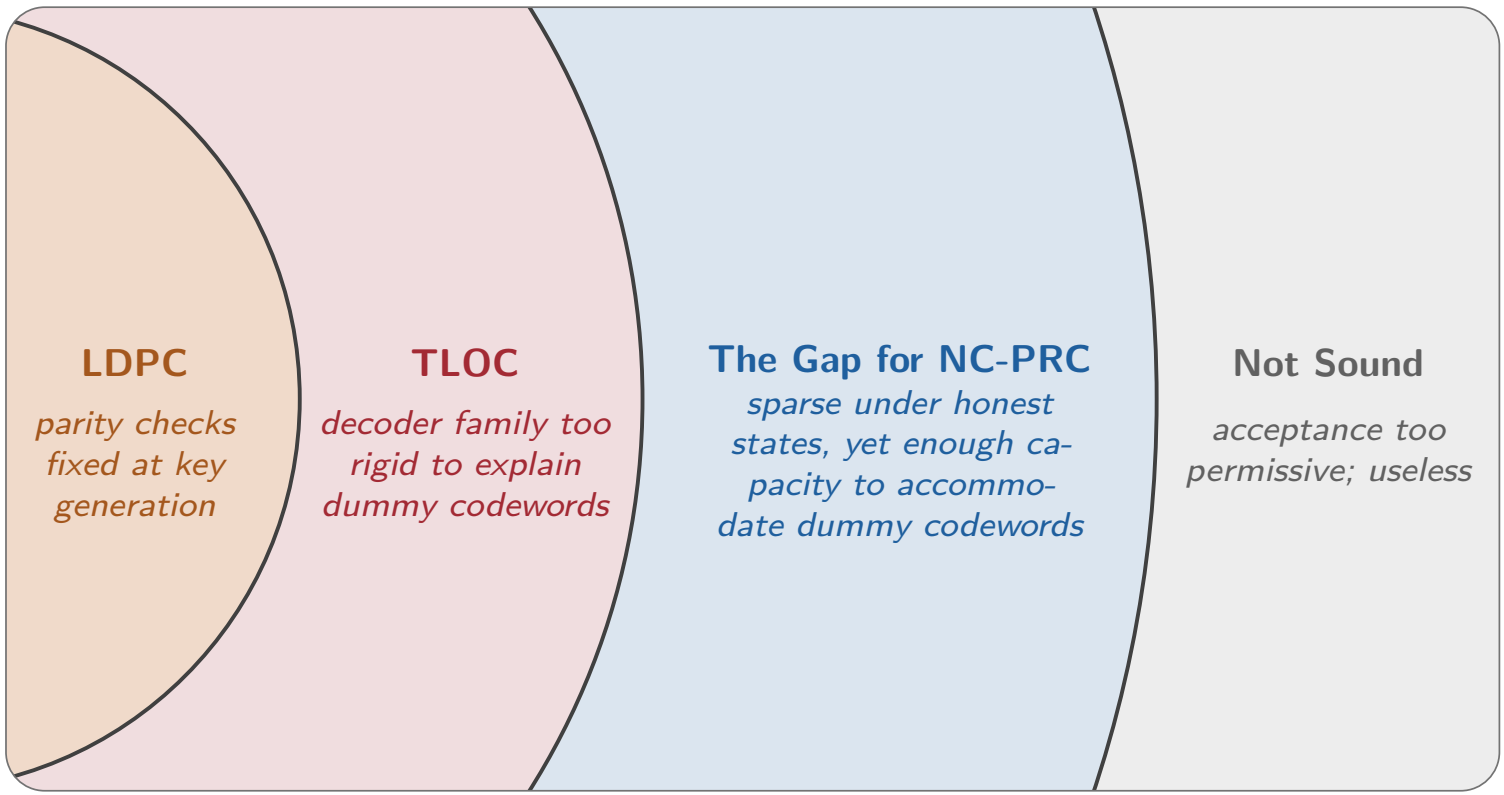
> Low opening capacity rules out non-committing codes.

> LDPC-based PRCs have low opening capacity, so they are *not* UC-secure against **adaptive corruption**.



[4] M. Christ and S. Gunn. "Pseudorandom Error-Correcting Codes". *CRYPTO 2024, Part VI*. vol. 14925. LNCS. 2024. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-68391-6_10

A Gap on Code Structure



Outline

A Background on Pseudorandom Code

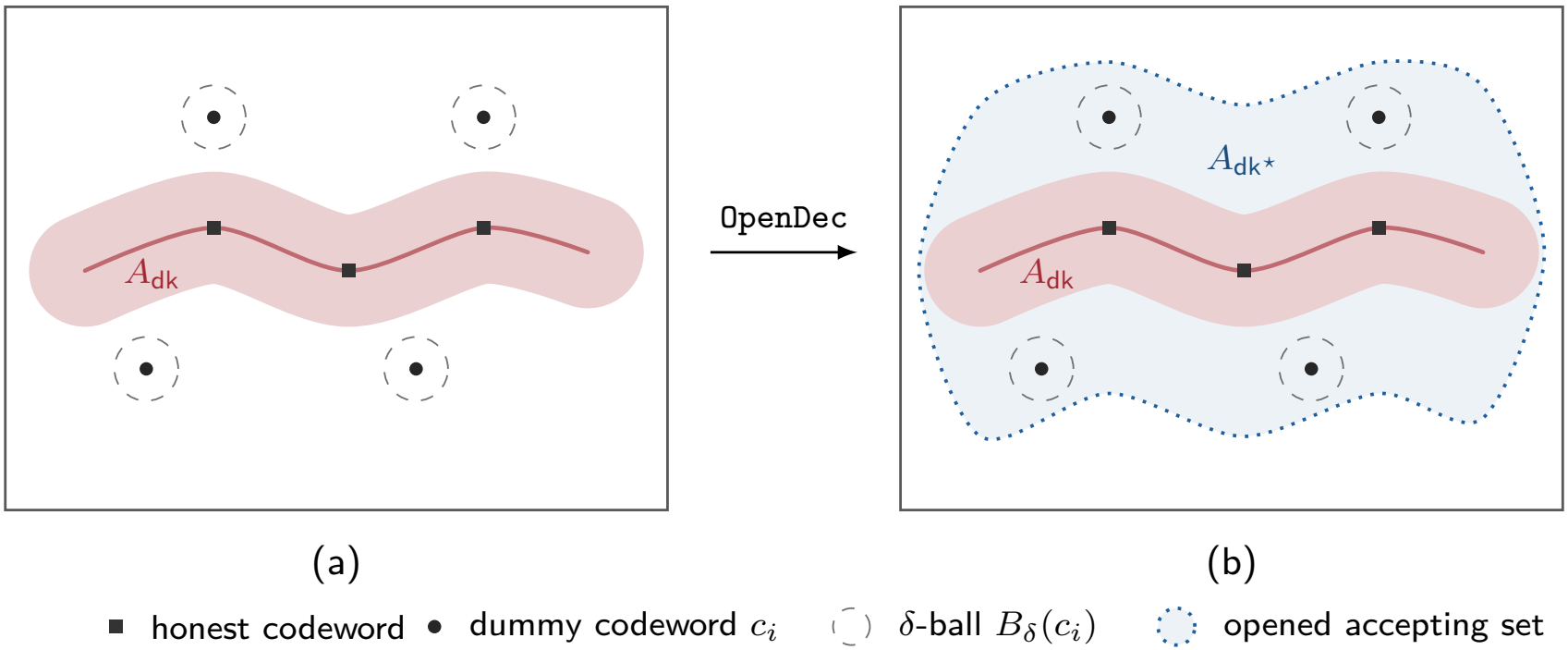
UC Security of PRC

(Decoder) Non-Committing Pseudorandom Code

A Gap on Code Structure

Construction for NC-PRCs

Idea: Programmable Acceptance



A Heuristic Secret-key NC-PRC

Error-Correcting Code

robustness

A Heuristic Secret-key NC-PRC

Error-Correcting Code

robustness

+

A Heuristic Secret-key NC-PRC

Error-Correcting Code

robustness

+

Puncturable PRF

pseudorandomness

A Heuristic Secret-key NC-PRC

Error-Correcting Code

robustness

+

Puncturable PRF

pseudorandomness

+

A Heuristic Secret-key NC-PRC

Error-Correcting Code

robustness

+

Puncturable PRF

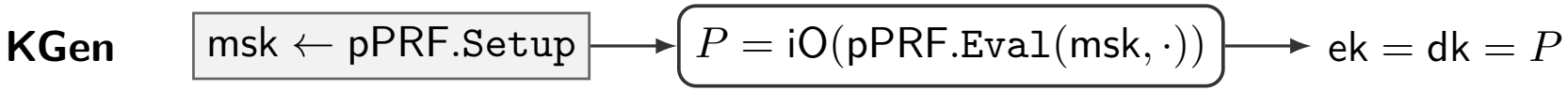
pseudorandomness

+

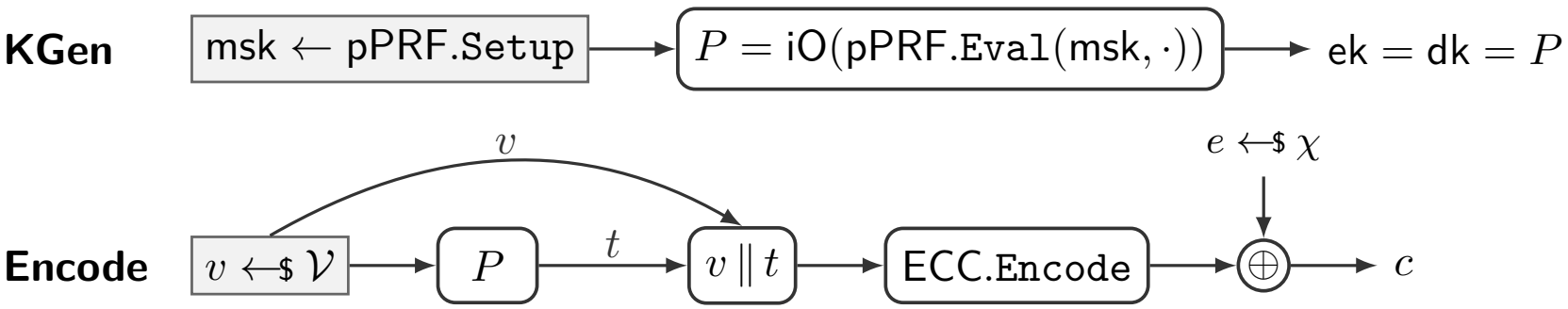
Indistinguishability Obfuscator (iO)

programmability

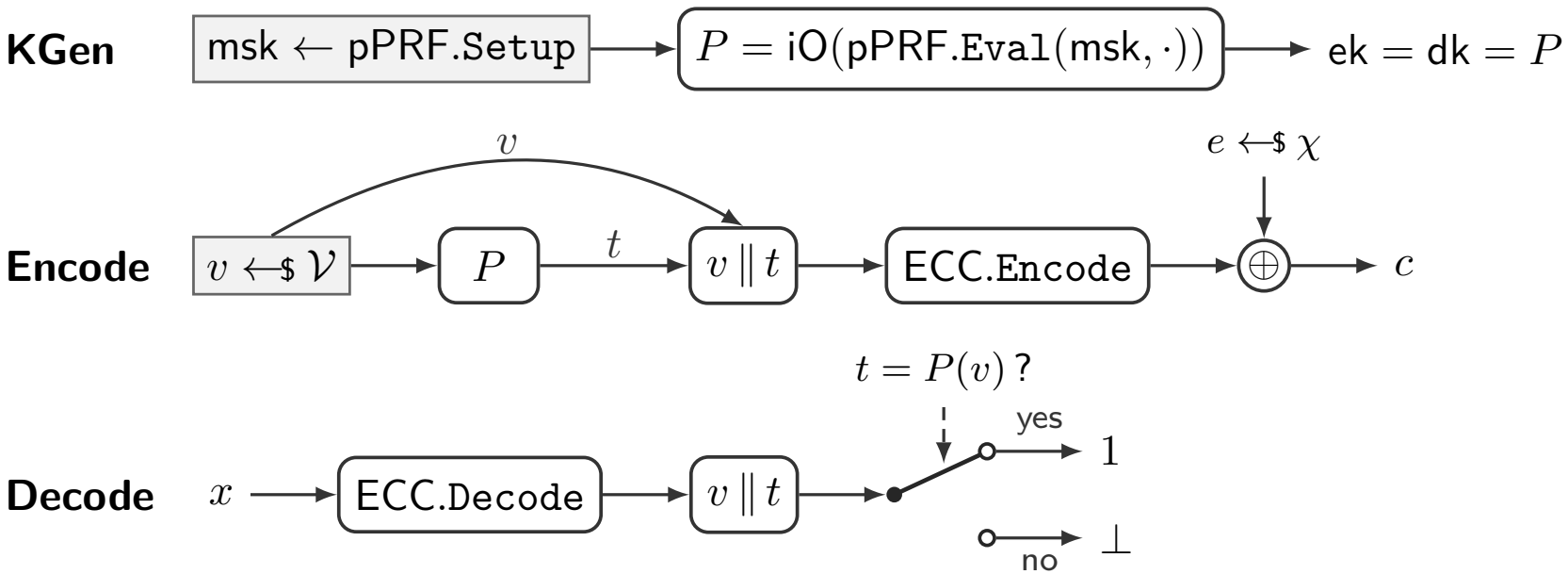
A Heuristic Secret-Key NC-PRC



A Heuristic Secret-Key NC-PRC



A Heuristic Secret-Key NC-PRC



A Heuristic NC-PRC: Opening the Decoder

dummy codewords

c_1

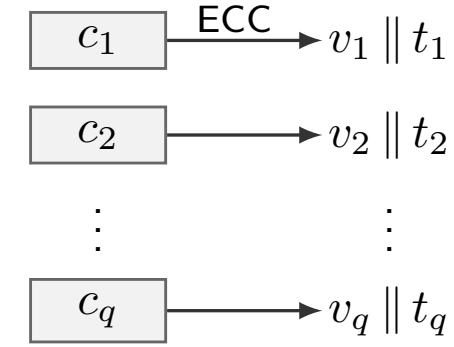
c_2

$\vdots$

c_q

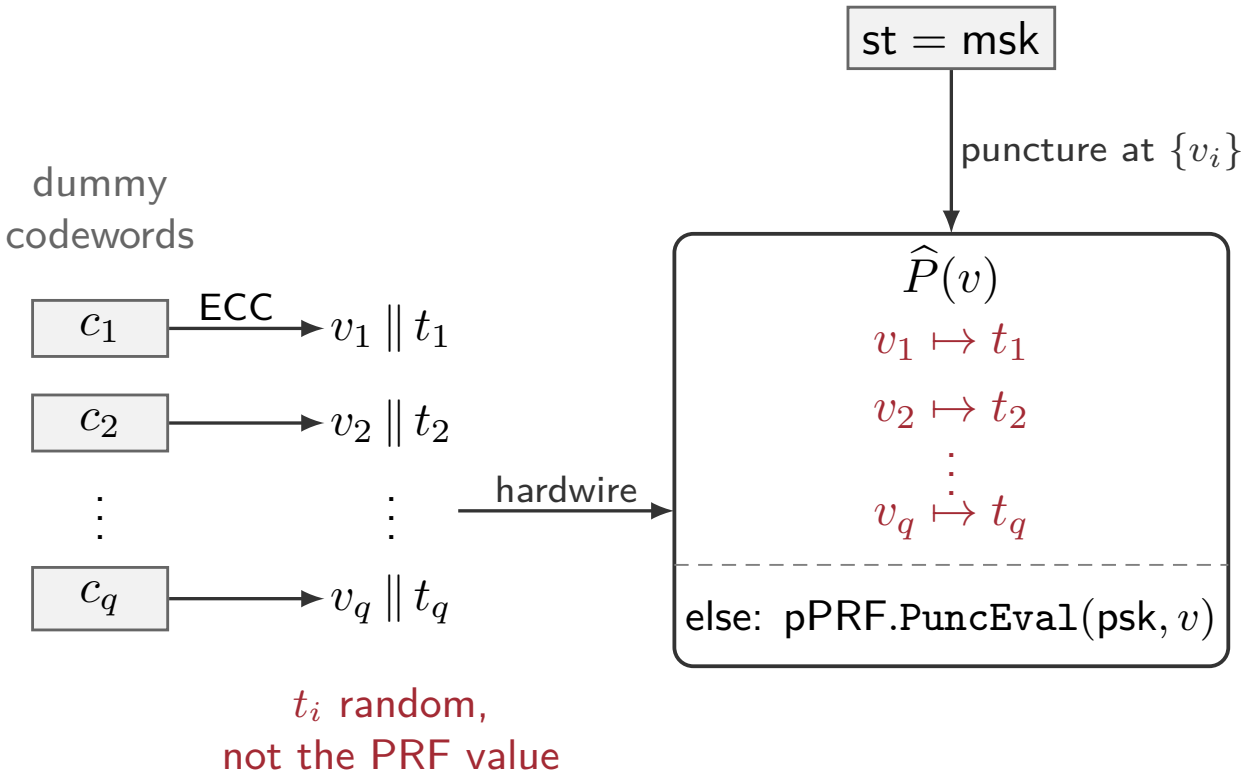
A Heuristic NC-PRC: Opening the Decoder

dummy codewords

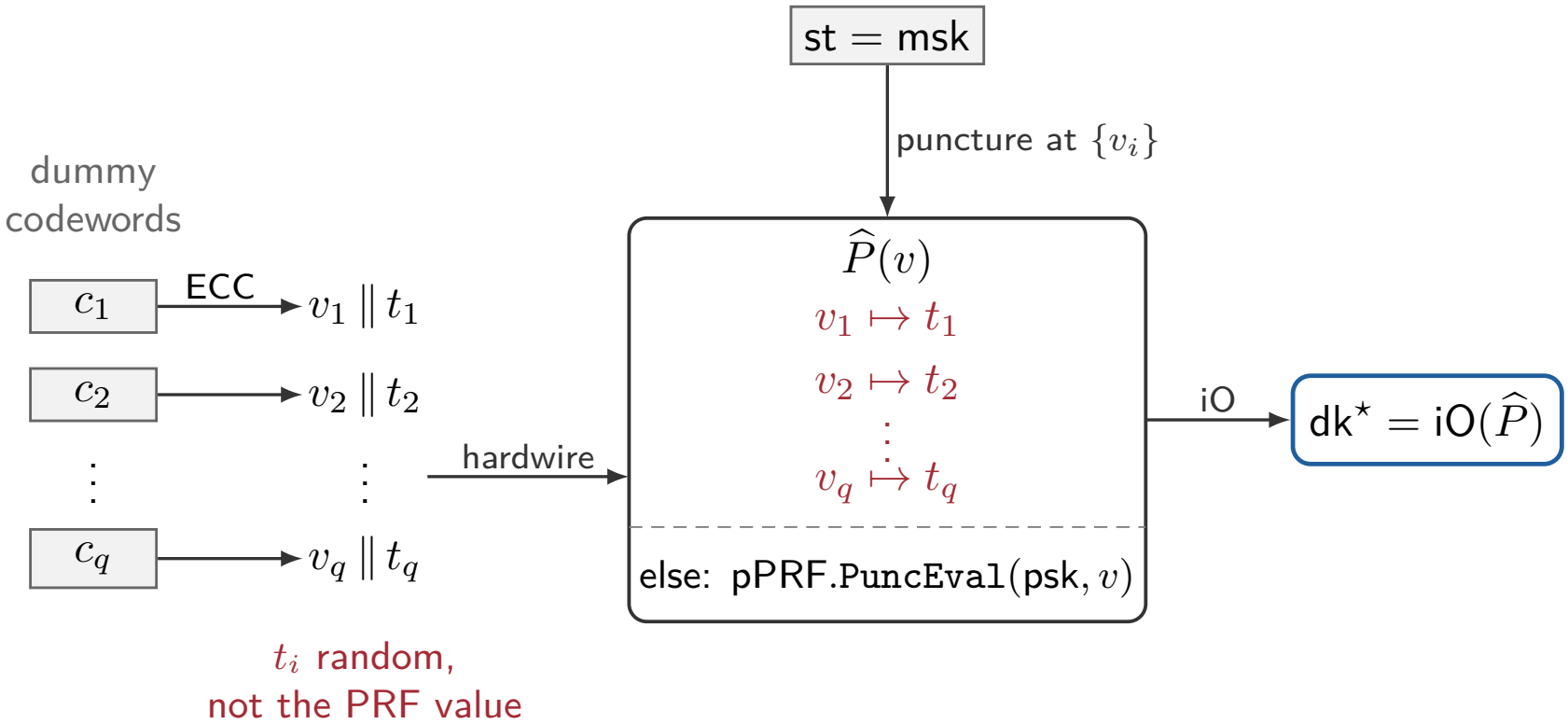


t_i random, not the PRF value

A Heuristic NC-PRC: Opening the Decoder



A Heuristic NC-PRC: Opening the Decoder





c_i and its δ-ball

ECC.Decode → $v_i \| t_i$ → $\widehat{P}(v_i) = t_i$ → ✓ **accepted**

$\mathsf{dk}^\star = \mathsf{iO}(\widehat{P})$ ≈ $\mathsf{dk} = P$

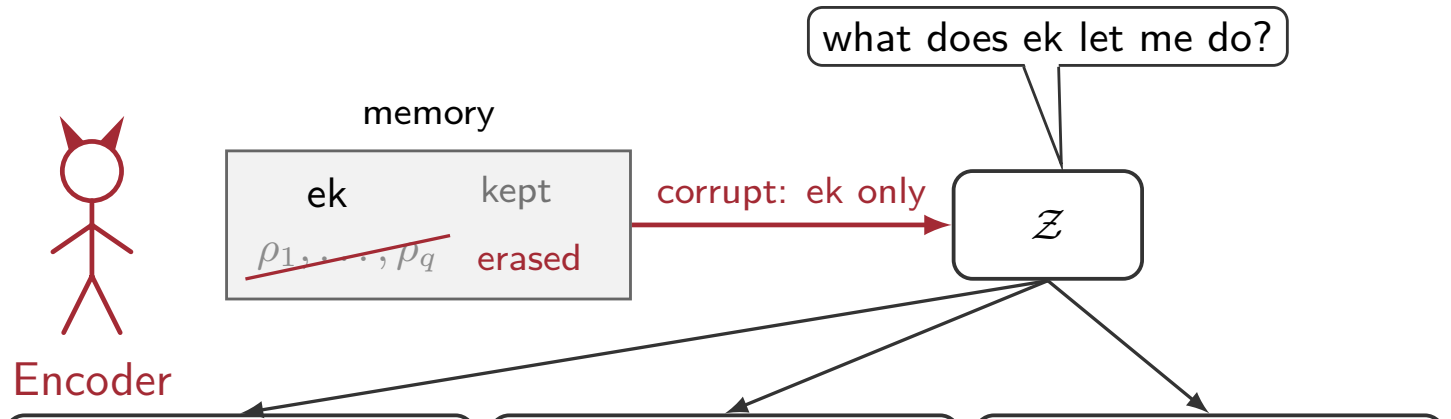
iO + pPRF security at the punctured $\{v_i\}$

Quick Take-Away

Scan for Full Version

1. **Non-adaptive corruption**: UC $\Longleftrightarrow$ Standalone Security
2. **Adaptive corruption**: non-committing PRC is necessary.
3. LDPC-based PRCs do NOT admit a non-committing PRC.
4. Non-committing PRCs exist (heuristically).

Encoder Corruption and Erasure



SK, ek $=$ dk
(our construction)
`Decode` ✓
decoder exposure,
explained by `OpenDec`

SK, ek $\neq$ dk
(LDPC [CG24][5])
`Encode` ✓ `Decode` ×
past c_i still
look random

PK
(ek is public)
$\mathcal{Z}$ had ek already
nothing new

Without erasure:

ρ_i kept $\xrightarrow{\mathcal{Z}}$ $\texttt{Encode}(\text{ek}, m_i; \rho_i) \stackrel{?}{=} c_i$ × for a dummy

so the coins need opening too; our impossibility uses decoder corruption only

[5] M. Christ and S. Gunn. "Pseudorandom Error-Correcting Codes". *CRYPTO 2024, Part VI*. vol. 14925. LNCS. 2024. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-031-68391-6_10

A Secret-Key NC-PRC (Algorithms)

- $\mathtt{KGen}(1^\lambda)$:
  1. $\mathsf{msk} \leftarrow \mathsf{pPRF}.\mathtt{Setup}(1^\lambda)$, $P := \mathsf{iO}\big(\mathsf{pPRF}.\mathtt{Eval}(\mathsf{msk}, \cdot)\big)$.
  2. $\mathsf{ek} := \mathsf{dk} := P$.
- $\mathtt{Encode}(\mathsf{ek}, 1)$ (zero-bit):
  1. Sample $v \leftarrow\!\!\$\ \mathcal{V}$ and noise $e \leftarrow\!\!\$\ \chi$.
  2. Set $t \leftarrow P(v)$ and output $c \leftarrow \mathsf{ECC}.\mathtt{Encode}(v \| t) \oplus e$.
- $\mathtt{Decode}(\mathsf{dk}, x)$:
  1. $v \| t \leftarrow \mathsf{ECC}.\mathtt{Decode}(x)$.
  2. If ECC fails, output $\perp$.
  3. If $t = P(v)$, output 1; otherwise output $\perp$.

A Secret-Key NC-PRC (Opening Algorithm)

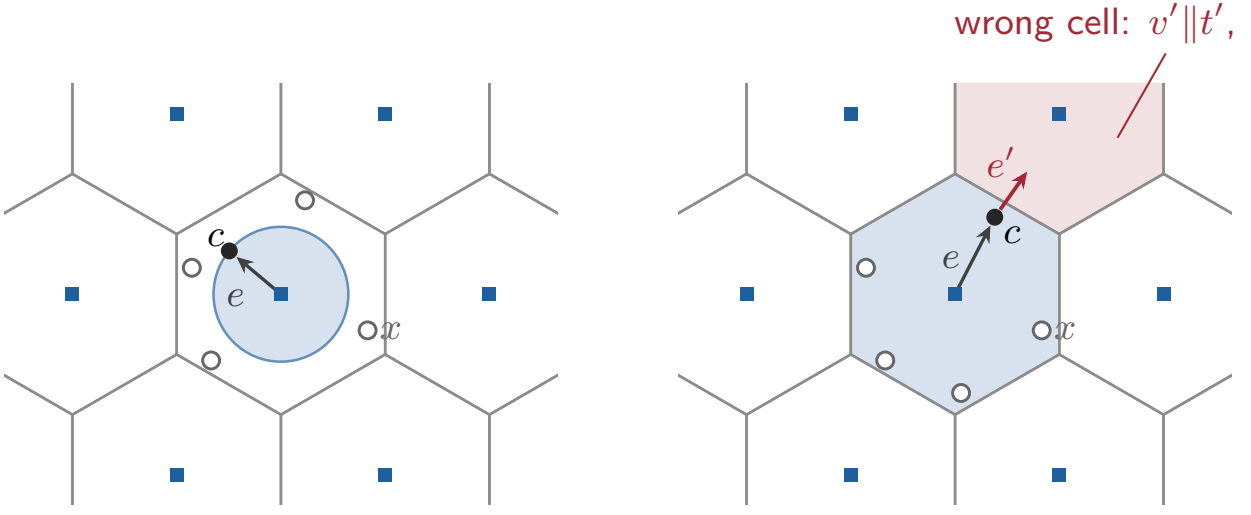
– $\mathtt{OpenDec}(\mathsf{st} := \mathsf{msk}, \mathcal{T} := \{(m_i, c_i)\}_{i=1}^{q})$:

1. For $i \in [q]$, $v_i \| t_i \leftarrow \mathsf{ECC}.\mathtt{Decode}(c_i)$, skipping c_i if ECC fails.
2. $\mathsf{psk} \leftarrow \mathsf{pPRF}.\mathtt{Puncture}(\mathsf{msk}, \{v_i\}_{i\in[q]})$, $P^\star := \mathsf{iO}(\widehat{P})$ where

$$\widehat{P}(v) := \begin{cases} t_i & \text{if } v = v_i \text{ for some } i \in [q], \\ \mathsf{pPRF}.\mathtt{PuncEval}(\mathsf{psk}, v) & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

3. Output $\mathsf{dk}^\star := P^\star$.

Why the Coding Layer Is Idealized



(a) small noise
robust ✓ pseudorandom ×
c stays near the center; a uniform x almost never does

(b) noise fills the cell
pseudorandom ✓ robust ×
c sits near an edge, like a uniform x; one more error e' crosses into the next cell

The code is *public*: anyone can measure the distance to the nearest center.
Way out: a *secret* code (LPN; a PRP per symbol over 2^λ alphabets), or an idealized code (this work).

A Public-Key NC-PRC

Error-Correcting Code

+

Smooth Projective Hash Function (SPHF)

A Public-Key NC-PRC

Let $L := \{u \in U : \exists\, w \in W : (u, w) \in \mathcal{R}\}$

- Sparsity

$$\Pr_{u \leftarrow\$ U}[u \in L] \leq \mathsf{negl}(\lambda)$$

- Subset Membership Indistinguishability

$$\left| \Pr_{(u,w) \leftarrow\$ \mathcal{R}}\left[\mathcal{A}(1^\lambda, u) = 1\right] - \Pr_{u \leftarrow\$ U}\left[\mathcal{A}(1^\lambda, u) = 1\right] \right| \leq \mathsf{negl}(\lambda)$$

- Correctness

$$\Pr[\mathsf{SPHF.Hash}(\mathsf{hk}, u) \neq \mathsf{SPHF.Proj}(\mathsf{hp}, u, w)] \leq \mathsf{negl}(\lambda)$$

A Public-Key NC-PRC

- $\texttt{KGen}(1^\lambda)$:
  1. $\mathsf{hk} \leftarrow \mathsf{SPHF}.\texttt{HashKG}(1^\lambda)$, $\mathsf{hp} \leftarrow \mathsf{SPHF}.\texttt{ProjKG}(\mathsf{hk})$.
  2. Output $\mathsf{ek} := \mathsf{hp}$ and $\mathsf{dk} := \mathsf{hk}$.
- $\texttt{Encode}(\mathsf{ek}, 1)$ (zero-bit):
  1. Sample $(u, w) \leftarrow\!\!\$\, U \times W$ such that $(u, w) \in \mathcal{R}$ and noise $e \leftarrow\!\!\$\, \chi$.
  2. Set $h \leftarrow \mathsf{SPHF}.\texttt{Proj}(\mathsf{hp}, u, w)$
  3. Output $c \leftarrow \mathsf{ECC}.\texttt{Encode}(u \| h) \oplus e$.
- $\texttt{Decode}(\mathsf{dk}, x)$:
  1. Compute $u \| h \leftarrow \mathsf{ECC}.\texttt{Decode}(x)$.
  2. If ECC fails, output $\perp$.
  3. If $h = \mathsf{SPHF}.\texttt{Hash}(\mathsf{hk}, u)$, output 1; otherwise output $\perp$.

A Public-Key NC-PRC

– $\texttt{OpenDec}(\mathsf{st} := (\mathsf{hk}, \mathsf{hp}), \mathcal{T} := \{(m_i, c_i)\}_{i=1}^{q})$:

1. For $i \in [q]$, recover $u_i \| h_i \leftarrow \mathsf{ECC.Decode}(c_i)$, skipping c_i if ECC fails or $u_i \in L$.
2. Sample $\mathsf{hk}^\star$ uniformly from

$$\mathcal{K}^\star := \left\{ \mathsf{hk}' : \begin{array}{l} \mathsf{SPHF.ProjKG}(\mathsf{hk}') = \mathsf{hp} \wedge \\ \forall i \in [q],\ \mathsf{SPHF.Hash}(\mathsf{hk}', u_i) = h_i \end{array} \right\}.$$

3. Output $\mathsf{dk}^\star := \mathsf{hk}^\star$; if $\mathcal{K}^\star = \varnothing$, output $\mathsf{dk}^\star := \mathsf{hk}$.